

San Mateo County CA SO Transparency Portal

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privacy. San Mateo County CA SO utilizes retroactive search to solve crimes after they've occurred. Additionally, San Mateo County CA SO utilizes real time alerting of hotlist vehicles to capture wanted criminals. Flock Safety technology also assists in the reuniting of missing persons with their loved ones. In an effort to ensure proper usage and guardrails are in place, San Mateo County CA SO have made the below policies and usage statistics available to the public.

Community Impact

Featured Success Stories

Success Story - Missing Person Safely Located

On 08/04/26 at approximately 11:00pm, the Sheriff’s Office was notified by another California law enforcement agency that a missing person's vehicle had been detected by Flock ALPR within the Sheriff's Office jurisdiction, near the City of San Carlos. The missing person was designated at risk due to age and ability to care for themselves. San Carlos deputies quickly located the missing person in downtown San Carlos, ensured their health and safety, and safely reunited them with their family. This case highlights how the cooperation and sharing of Flock ALPR access with partnering agencies can help reunite families with their missing loved ones.

Success Story - Occupied Stolen Vehicle

On Sunday, 07/05/26, at about 5:30am, deputies received a FLOCK alert regarding a vehicle with stolen license plates in the area of Woodside Rd. and Alameda De Las Pulgas. By tracking the suspect vehicle via FLOCK, deputies were able to locate the occupied vehicle in the 100 block of Northgate Dr. in Woodside. Deputies successfully stopped the vehicle and during a thorough investigation, discovered that both the vehicle and the license plates were stolen. The occupants of the vehicle also possessed possible ID theft information, several other stolen license plates, a variety of power tools, and suspected methamphetamine. The stolen vehicle was ultimately released to the registered owner. Both suspects were arrested and booked into the San Mateo County Jail for violations of numerous criminal statutes. FLOCK was integral to the identification and location of the suspect vehicle. This case highlights how proactive enforcement and the use of FLOCK can solve crimes and prevent future ones.

Success Story - Felony Hit & Run

On 07/01/26, at approximately 6:45 p.m., deputies responded to Woodside Rd. and Hacienda Dr. in Woodside following a reported hit-and-run collision. Upon arrival, deputies learned the victim was riding a horse along the shoulder of the road, which is commonly used by bicyclists and equestrians, when a vehicle struck the horse from behind and fled the scene. Both the horse and rider sustained injuries but survived. Through witness statements and investigative tools, including

FLOCK, deputies identified the involved vehicle and registered owners. Deputies are continuing to conduct follow-up investigative work, including collecting and reviewing all available evidence. The use of FLOCK greatly reduced the time it took for deputies to identify the suspect vehicle.

Success Story - Residential Burglary

On 06/15/2026, deputies investigated a report of a 2-day old residential burglary in the Town of Woodside. Home security footage showed two suspects entering the garage on the property and rummaging through items. When the home's alarm system activated, the suspects fled. Deputies reviewed the footage, which showed the vehicle the suspects were driving. Using FLOCK, deputies identified the vehicle and focused their investigation. On 06/16/26, deputies located the vehicle in Redwood City. Two suspects were arrested for PC 460(A): Residential Burglary. Though this case was reported 2-days after the crime occurred, FLOCK allowed deputies to quickly identify and arrest the suspects.

Success Story - Road Rage / Firearm / Narcotics

On 06/14/2026, around 8:30 p.m., deputies were dispatched to a location in Montara following reports of a road rage incident. During the incident, the suspect reportedly pointed a firearm at the victim, was speeding, and driving erratically. The suspect fled the area, but witnesses were able to provide a description of the suspect and the vehicle he was driving. Using FLOCK, deputies identified the vehicle and were able to focus their search efforts. A short time later, deputies located the suspect nearby. During the investigation, deputies located a semi-automatic firearm, ammunition, narcotics, illegal fireworks, and a false registration tab in the suspect’s possession. The suspect, who was already prohibited from possessing firearms, was arrested on several charges including: PC 245(A)(2): Assault with a firearm, PC 29800(a)(1): Felon in possession of a firearm, and HS 11351: Possession of a controlled substance for sale. The use of FLOCK in this case greatly shortened the time it took for deputies to locate and safely arrest a dangerous felon.

Success Story - Stolen Vehicle

On 06/06/2026, Sheriff's Deputies in unincorporated Redwood City were alerted to a stolen vehicle in the area, via a FLOCK notification. Deputies responded to the area and quickly located the occupied vehicle. Deputies initiated a traffic stop but the driver failed to yield, which led to a short vehicle pursuit. At the conclusion of the pursuit, deputies safely and successfully took the juvenile driver into custody. The driver was also in possession of burglary tools. He was arrested for possession of a stolen vehicle, evading a peace officer with wanton disregard for public safety, and possession of burglary tools. This case highlights the effectiveness of using FLOCK's automated license plate reader (ALPR) technology in supporting public safety and preventing future crimes.

Success Story - Residential Burglary/Package Thefts from Apartments

On 08/06/2024 and 08/07/2024, during the early morning hours, two suspects entered different apartment buildings in San Carlos without access or authorization. These suspects entered the mailrooms and stole multiple packages from both buildings. Using surveillance video, detectives obtained descriptions of the suspects and their vehicle. Through FLOCK, a suspect vehicle was located. Detectives and deputies identified one of the involved suspects, who was on post-release community supervision out of Alameda County. They arranged for the probation officer to bring the suspect into the Hayward Probation Office. Detectives contacted the suspect at the office and found additional evidence related to these cases. This case is under review by the San Mateo County District Attorney for prosecution.

Success Story - Arson via Molotov Cocktail

On 05/16/2024, around 3:00am, a suspect threw a Molotov cocktail at a residence in San Carlos. The fire spread rapidly, resulting in the destruction of two vehicles, part of a residential garage, some exterior property, and a section of a tree. Fortunately, the residents managed to escape the area unharmed. Using surveillance video and FLOCK, investigators identified a suspect vehicle that left the area shortly after the incident. With this information, they were able to develop additional leads on the suspect. Search warrants were issued and investigators obtained additional surveillance footage and FLOCK images, which clearly linked the suspect to the arson. This information resulted in the arrest of a suspect, who was prosecuted for arson of an inhabited structure by the San Mateo County District Attorney.

Success Story - Best Buy Serial Computer/Laptop Thief

On 02/23/2024 and 03/23/2024, a suspect entered the Best Buy in San Carlos and stole multiple computers and laptops valued at approximately $3,000. A suspect vehicle was observed fleeing the scene, and FLOCK enabled deputies to obtain a license plate for the vehicle. Detectives identified a family member of the registered vehicle owner who matched

the suspect's description. It was discovered that this suspect had committed similar thefts at Best Buy stores throughout the Bay Area. Detectives and deputies learned of a new suspect vehicle being used by the perpetrator, and FLOCK assisted in identifying this vehicle. In April 2024, deputies and detectives monitored the suspect and the vehicle in question. The suspect returned to the Best Buy in San Carlos on 04/27/2024, where he was arrested for the previous thefts.

Data & Usage Summary

Data Retention

The number of days data is retained.

30 days

Total Cameras

Number of LPR and other cameras.

109

Vehicles detected in the last 30 days

Number of unique plate reads over the last 30 days.

1,193,387

Number of Searches

Total user search sessions over the last 30 days.

867

Hotlists Alerted On

National and statewide hotlist sources.

California SVS, NCMEC Amber Alert

Number of Hotlist Hits

Total hotlist hits over the last 30 days.

6,318

Sharing Network Data With

Organizations granted access to San Mateo County CA SO data.

Alameda CA PD	Alameda County CA SO
Antioch CA PD	Atherton CA PD
Belmont CA PD	Belvedere CA PD
Benicia CA PD	Berkeley CA PD
Brentwood CA PD	Brisbane CA PD
Burlingame CA PD	Cal Fire
California Department of Corrections	California Department of Fish & Wildlife (CA)
California Highway Patrol	California State Parks
Calistoga CA PD	Campbell CA PD

Capitola CA PD	City of Monte Sereno CA
Clayton CA PD	Cloverdale CA PD
Colma CA PD	Concord CA PD
Contra Costa County CA SO	Cotati CA PD
Daly City CA PD	Danville CA PD
Dixon CA PD	Dublin CA PD (ACSO)
East Bay Parks CA PD	East Palo Alto CA PD
Emeryville CA PD	Fairfield CA PD
Foster City CA PD	Fremont CA PD
Gilroy CA PD	Hayward CA PD
Hercules CA PD	Hillsborough CA PD
Livermore CA PD	Los Altos CA PD
Los Gatos CA	Marin County CA DA
Marin County CA SO	Menlo Park CA PD
Mill Valley CA PD	Milpitas CA PD
Moraga CA PD	Morgan Hill CA PD
Napa CA PD	Napa County CA SO
NCRIC	Newark CA PD
Novato CA PD	Oakland CA PD
Oakley CA PD	Pacifica CA PD
Palo Alto CA PD	Petaluma CA PD
Piedmont CA PD	Pleasant Hill CA PD
Pleasanton CA PD	Redwood City CA PD
Richmond CA PD	Rio Vista CA PD
Rohnert Park Department of Public Safety (CA)	San Bruno CA PD
San Francisco CA PD	San Francisco District Attorney CA
San Jose CA PD	San Leandro CA PD
San Mateo CA PD	San Pablo CA PD
San Rafael CA PD	San Ramon CA PD
Santa Clara CA PD	Santa Clara County CA SO
Santa Clara DA CA	Santa Rosa CA PD
Sausalito CA PD	Solano County CA SO

Solano County DA CA | Sonoma County CA SO
South San Francisco CA PD | St. Helena CA PD
Suisun City CA PD | Sunnyvale CA PD
Tiburon CA PD | Town of Woodside CA (SMCSO)
Union City CA PD | Vacaville CA PD
Vallejo CA PD | Walnut Creek CA PD
Watsonville CA PD

Policy & Trust

What's Detected

> License Plates, Vehicles

What's Not Detected

> Facial recognition, People, Gender, Race

Acceptable Use Policy

> Data is used for law enforcement purposes only. Data is owned by San Mateo County CA SO and is never sold to 3rd parties.

Prohibited Uses

> Immigration enforcement, traffic enforcement, harrassment or intimidation, usage based solely on a protected class (i.e. race, sex, religion), Personal use.

Access Policy

> All system access requires a valid reason and is stored indefinitely.

Hotlist Policy

> Hotlist hits are required to be human verified prior to action.

More Info

San Mateo Sheriff's Office ALPR Policy

> https://www.smcsheriff.com/sites/default/files/content_files/Automated_License_Plate_Readers__ALPRs__0.pdf